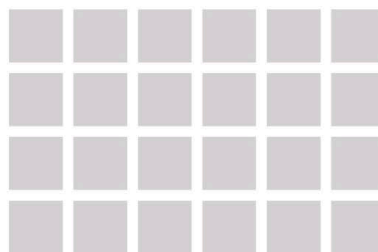


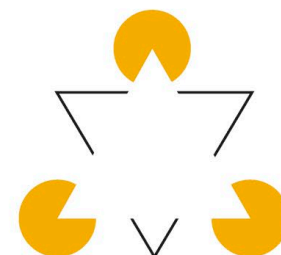


Illusions

An illusion occurs when what the eye sees is interpreted by the brain in a way that does not match up with the physical reality of the actual image. With so many competing signals going to the brain, it tends to look for familiar patterns. It also tries to predict what will happen next to compensate for the slight time delay between stimulus and perception. Both these facts can lead to our brain misinterpreting visual stimuli. Illusions fall into three main classes: physiological, cognitive, and physical.



HERMANN GRID



KANIZSA'S TRIANGLE

Physiological

Physiological illusions are thought to arise from excessive or competing stimuli, such as brightness, color, movement, and position. In this grid, gray spots seem to appear at the intersections as your eyes flick over them but vanish when you stare at them.

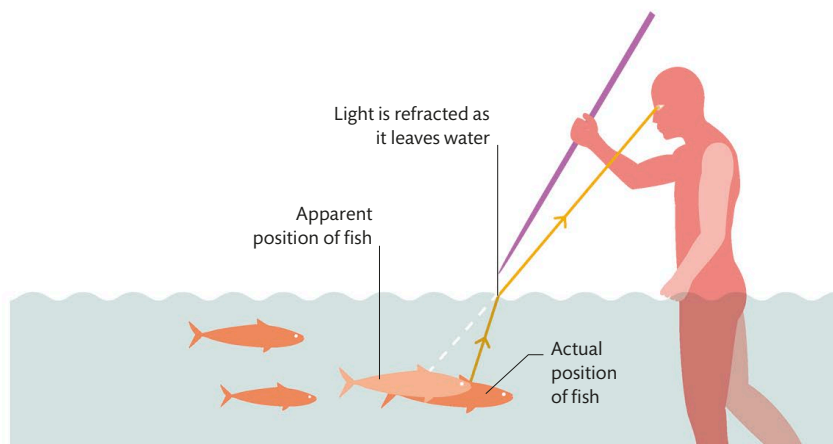
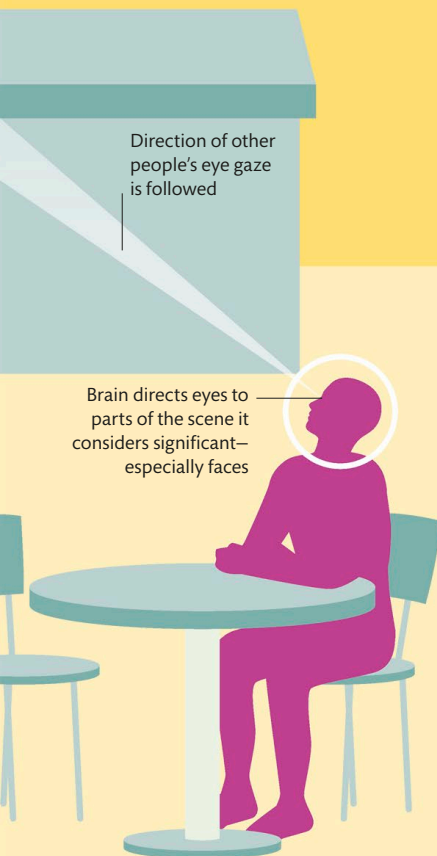
Cognitive

Cognitive illusions happen when the brain makes assumptions about movement or perspective when viewing an object. Sometimes these can lead to the brain switching between two different images or seeing a shape that is not there.



Direction of other people's eye gaze is followed

Brain directs eyes to parts of the scene it considers significant—especially faces



REFRACTION

Physical

Physical illusions are caused by the optical properties of the physical environment, particularly water. The brain cannot take account of the way that light bends as it passes between water and air, so it sees the fish as further back than it actually is.

SOME MAMMALS
AND BIRDS ARE
ALSO FOOLED BY
OPTICAL ILLUSIONS

